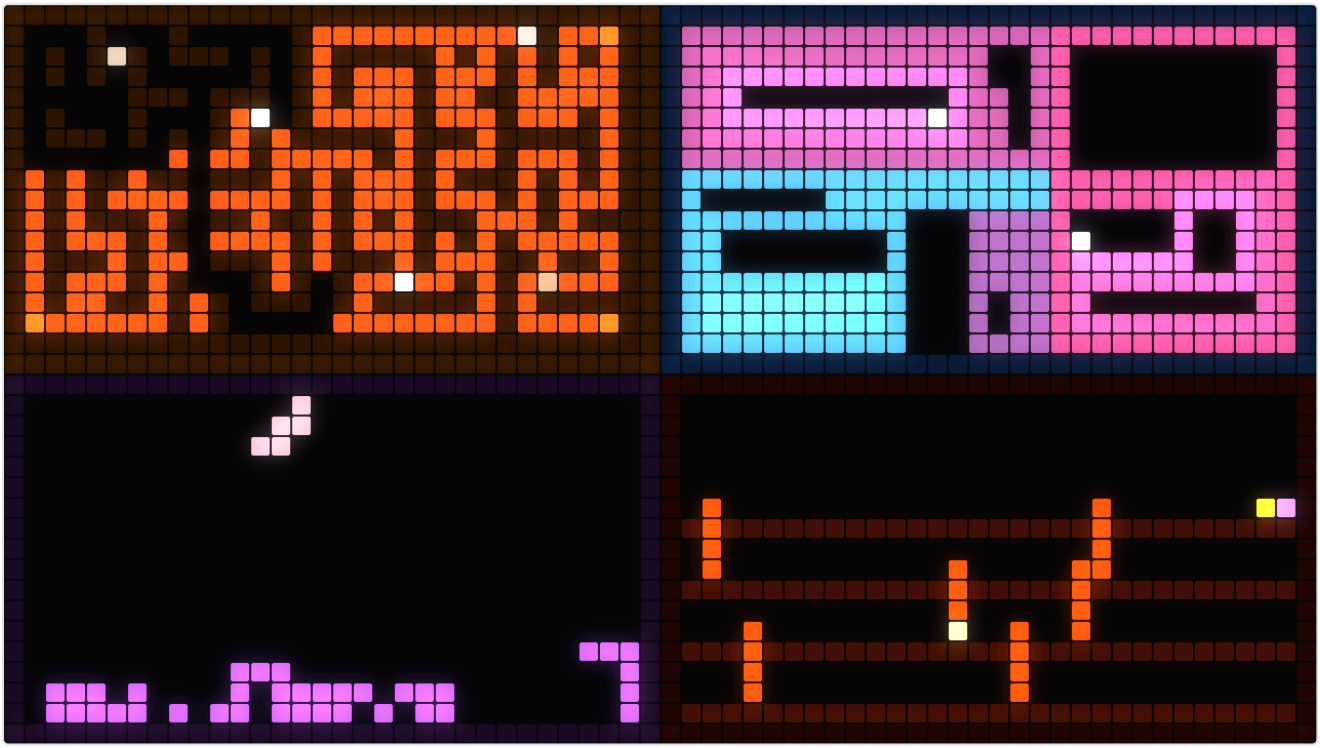
Coinop user guide

Coinop is **fourteen playable arcade games** for Resolume Arena and Avenue, as a pair of FFGL plugins, driven by MIDI or OSC or left to play themselves.



Four of the fourteen, on four of the six palettes: Chase on Amber, Trails on Ice, Stacker on Candy, Girders on Fire.

> **Before you rely on this:** the games are verified by a harness that drives the real game classes with no graphics API present and asserts on simulation state: 243 checks covering per-game determinism, the three host-timing defences, and each game's own invariants: Snake's turn queue, Bricks' tunnelling and its two degenerate-angle locks, Chase's maze loops and reversal ban, Flapper's swept collision. A second harness compiles the shaders in a headless GL context and measures what they draw (31 checks). The browser demo re-implements all fourteen in JavaScript and **agrees with the C++ byte for byte** on a playfield digest.
>
> **It's never been loaded into Resolume.** The FFGL parameter and clock plumbing is the part no harness here reaches. The Windows build does compile and ship; it's just never been run in a Windows host either. Try it on a spare layer first.
>
> This codebase was created with AI assistance, directed and reviewed by a human author.

Installing

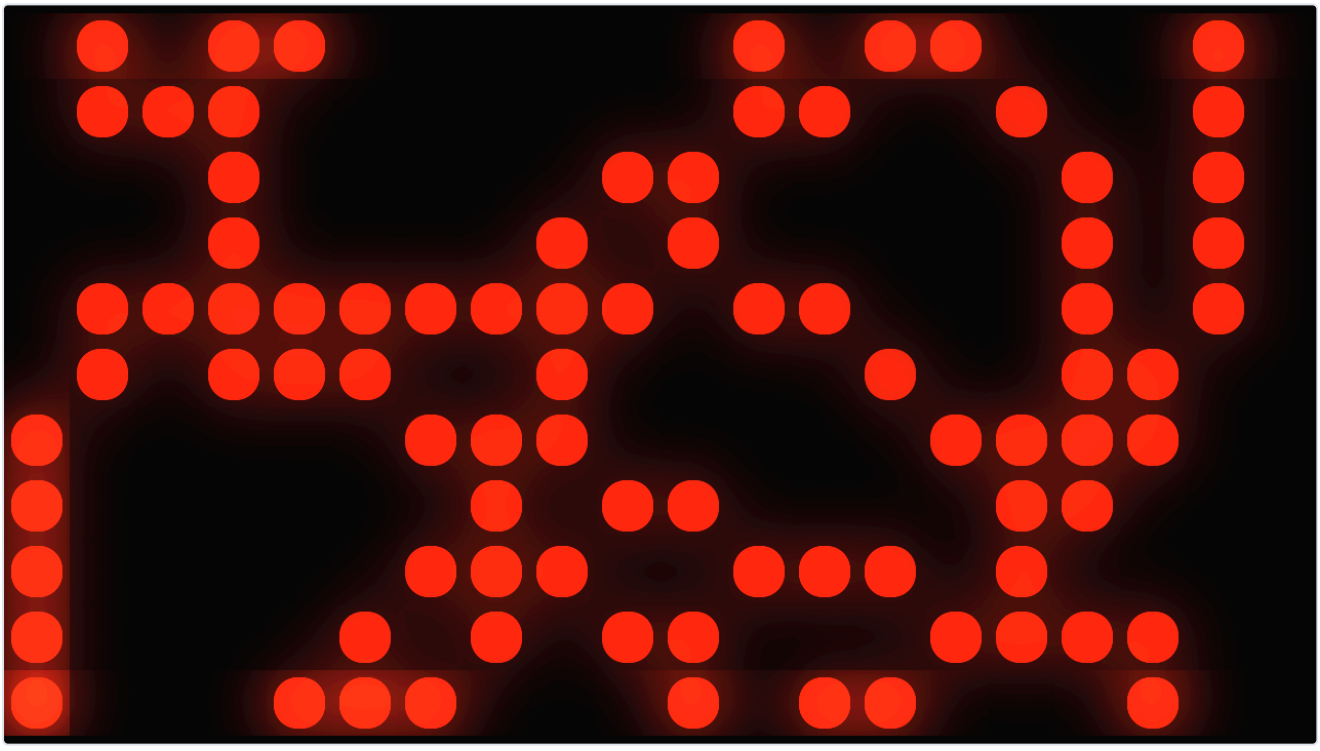
Drop both plugins into `~/Documents/Resolume Arena/Extra Effects` (or the Avenue equivalent) and restart Resolume. The macOS builds are signed and notarised; the Windows builds are unsigned, but only the installer trips SmartScreen.

`Coinop` is a **source**. `Coinop Over` is an **effect**, and in the effect the brick field can be built out of the incoming clip, so breaking a brick punches a hole through to the layer below.

The two things it is for

A generator that's never the same twice. A seeded game that plays itself, resets when it loses, and has an intensity that climbs through a run and drops when it restarts. That's a different shape from a loop, and it's why Autoplay is on by default and why the autopilot **loses on purpose**.

Pixel mapping. The composition *is* the fixture layout, Resolume's pixel mapper samples it, and the playfield is what the lights do.



The same Drift, with the grid coarsened to nineteen cells and the gaps opened.

That second job is why everything is drawn as **cells**, why the grid size is a parameter, and why even the vector game is rasterised: a hairline vector lands between fixtures and disappears.

Playing it

FFGL doesn't have a keyboard or a gamepad. It has parameters, and Resolume will MIDI- or OSC-map any of them, so every control is a parameter:

Parameter	Good for
Paddle	A fader or an OSC float. The nicest way to play Bricks and Rally.
Left / Right / Up / Down	Four pads. Steering, Rally's second player, Stacker's rotate, Duel's block.
Fire	One pad. Shoot, launch, thrust, hard-drop, strike — and in Snake, "turn right".
Autoplay	On by default. The autopilot plays, and loses on purpose.
Skill	How competent the autopilot is. At 1.0 it plays a long game.
Seed	Same seed, same game.

Rally is two players in one plugin instance: one on the Paddle, one on Up/Down.

The fourteen

Game	What it is
Snake	Grows, turns, traps itself. Two buttons or four.
Bricks	Ball, paddle, brick field. Best played with a fader.
Marchers	A formation that steps down the screen and shoots back.
Rally	Two paddles, one ball. Two players, one plugin instance.
Drift	Rotating ship, splitting rocks, wrapping playfield.
Stacker	Falling polyominoes. Contiguous runs clear, not full rows.
Chase	A maze carved fresh each level, pellets, four pursuers.
Girders	Climb the floors while the hazards cascade back down them.
Swarm	A formation attackers peel out of, dive from, and rejoin.
Trails	Riders that never stop, leaving walls. Last one alive.
Reflex	A prompt, a closing window, and the right button or nothing.
Rafters	Hit the floor from below to flip what is standing on it.
Duel	Two fighters. Wind-up, active, recovery. Best of three.
Flapper	One button against gravity, through the gaps in a moving wall.

The mechanics are the public domain part; the names aren't. None of these is named after what it descends from, and none copies the parts a court has held to be protected expression: the playfield is whatever the Grid parameter says, and colour comes from the palette by role.

Setting it up as a generator

1. **Autoplay on, Skill around 0.6.** High enough to be watchable, low enough that it loses often enough for the run to have a shape.
2. **Set the Seed** if you want the same run every night, and leave it alone if you don't. This is the control that decides whether the piece is repeatable.
3. **Coarsen the Grid** until the cells read at the distance the audience is at. For a pixel map, set it to the fixture count and stop thinking of it as a picture.
4. **Pick a palette.** Six of them, applied by role rather than by literal colour, which is what lets the same game read on Amber and on Ice.

If it looks wrong

It plays too well and never resets. Skill is at 1.0, where the autopilot plays a long game, which is the opposite of what a generator wants.

Nothing moves. Autoplay is off and nothing is mapped. Map Fire to a pad, or turn Autoplay back on.

The picture is a mush on the pixel map. The Grid is finer than the fixture count. Coarsen it until one cell is one fixture, and open the gaps.

Bricks feels unplayable. Use the **Paddle** float from a fader rather than Left/Right pads. The game was tuned for a continuous control.
